

FinTrust Cost Governance and Reporting

Week 12 | reporting flow, multi-account guardrails and configuration response

Billing data	Report process	Schedule
Cost Explorer Client region: us-east-1 Service and linked-account grouping	Cost-reporting module CSV and escaped HTML Optional S3 upload under a month prefix	EventBridge First Monday, 08:00 SAST Lambda permission limited to the rule

The report path is intentionally controlled: Cost Explorer reads consolidated billing data, the application writes local artefacts first, and upload happens only when the bucket is configured at runtime.

Spot capacity	Checkpointed batch can restart	Use for fault-tolerant batch work, not strict payment availability.
Compute Savings Plan	EC2, Lambda or Fargate flexibility	Choose when family or Region can change.
EC2 Instance Savings Plan	Stable family and Region	Choose for highest discount on predictable EC2 use.
Tagging	Cost Centre and environment chargeback	Activate tags in Billing and enforce them at provisioning.

All cost figures in the Week 12 lessons are teaching scenarios. This diagram does not represent an AWS account, a completed upload or measured savings.

Multi-Account Permission Layers

An allowed identity policy does not overcome a guardrail above it. Start troubleshooting with an explicit deny.

Organisation SCP	Permission boundary	Identity and resource policies
Sets the maximum permission Explicit deny wins Does not apply to the management account	Limits what a role can receive Cannot grant permissions Prevents privilege escalation	Need an applicable allow Cross-account S3 needs both Explicit resource deny wins

Developer cannot create EC2 in an unapproved Region	Region restriction SCP	Confirm the region is intentionally outside the approved list before requesting policy change.
Lambda can read but not write to a bucket in another account	Missing identity or target bucket allow	Ensure both the role policy and bucket policy allow the cross-account write.
Administrator cannot create IAM roles	Permission boundary	Review the approved boundary instead of adding more identity permissions.

Guardrails in this portfolio are example SCP documents based on the course scenarios. They have not been attached to an AWS Organisation.

Visibility, Drift and Remediation

The monitoring trio answers different questions. Governance works when findings become reviewed, controlled action.

CloudWatch	CloudTrail	AWS Config
Question: is it performing? Metrics, logs, alarms Use for Lambda throttles and duration	Question: who made the call? Management events by default Select data events for high-value resources	Question: is it compliant? Configuration history and rules Detect public-bucket or tag violations

Config identifies a non-compliant resource	A managed or custom rule evaluates a resource on change or on schedule.	Detection does not itself repair a resource.
EventBridge routes the finding	A rule matches the non-compliant evaluation and directs it to Lambda or SSM Automation.	The route should be limited to the intended compliance event.
Remediation and review	Lambda or SSM can restore public-access controls and notify the owner.	Automation needs least privilege and a record for review.
CloudFormation drift	Drift detection reports changes outside a template; a change set previews a correction.	A human must decide whether to update the template or restore the resource.

This page is a design and learning aid. No remediation, CloudFormation deployment or production drift check is claimed as completed.